

DAVID MULLIN | STUART NEUMANN

Two Rounds Rewrite the Record Book

Stuart Neumann's historic net score matched David Mullin shot for shot on the gross card, as both broke the Boavista course record in the same round.

The course record at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort was 83. It had survived 40 prior visits. On the second round it was broken twice in the same afternoon, by David Mullin and Stuart Neumann, both of whom signed for 82 gross. Records tend to fall to one man. This one was dismantled by committee.

Neumann's round was worth -9 net. That is the best round in TEG history to date, a sentence he will be repeating for years and nobody can stop him. His +11 gross matched Mullin's +11, jointly the best gross round ever recorded here. Let us be clear about what that means. The two finest rounds of golf in the history of this competition were both eleven over par.

For Mullin it was a personal best, his -4 net eclipsing anything he had managed before. Both men also set course personal bests. Mullin had never beaten 83 at Boavista across eight prior visits. Neumann's previous best there was 89, making this an improvement of 15 strokes on his last appearance. He had clearly been saving himself.

Mullin stayed top of both the 2012 Trophy and the 2012 Green Jacket standings, extending his leads to three and fourteen shots respectively. At the foot of the table, Henry Meller relieved Neumann of last place in the 2012 Wooden Spoon race. He now trails by 15.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Stuart NEUMANN (-9)
TROPHY LEAD David MULLIN, 3 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD David MULLIN, 14 ahead

ROUND NET VP SN -9 GW -6 DM -4 JB 0 HM +10
ROUND GROSS DM +11 SN +11 JB +22 GW +27 HM +30
AFTER R2 • TROPHY DM -7 GW -4 SN -3 JB -2 HM +13
AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET DM +23 SN +37 JB +42 HM +53 GW +62

THE RACES

Standing Still Costs Jon Baker

A level-par round was enough to see Jon Baker overtaken twice over, while the Wooden Spoon race changed hands completely.

At Boavista in TEG 9's second round, Gregg Williams posted the best round of his career, finishing six-under-par net. It was enough to leapfrog Jon Baker. Baker had gone round level par, which is a perfectly respectable thing to do and, on this particular day, entirely beside the point.

Neumann matched the move stroke for stroke. A poor first-round 6-over became a nine-under second round, a swing of 15 shots. It also carried him clear of the Wooden Spoon cellar he had occupied overnight. He vacated the premises without leaving a note.

The tenancy passed to Henry Meller. A double bogey on the par-5 3rd sent him from fourth to last in the TEG 9 Wooden Spoon standings, flipping the race entirely. David Mullin, meanwhile, retained his TEG 9 Trophy lead. The gap to the chasing pack widened from one shot to three. He did it with a card that was eleven over par. Round here, that is what command looks like.

HENRY MELLER

Three Holes Undo Henry Meller

A quadruple, a triple and a quintuple bogey in a row turned a tidy front nine into the tournament's worst stretch of golf.

Henry Meller's round 2 at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort was undone in one stretch of three holes. Across the 14th, 15th and 16th he bled 12 shots. Not one net par among them.

It opened with a quadruple-bogey 7 on the par-3 14th. A par 3 is a hole designed to be over quickly. He continued with a triple bogey on the par-4 15th, stroke index 1, the hardest hole on the

course and therefore the least surprising item on the charge sheet. Then came the quintuple-bogey 10 on the par-5 16th, his worst hole of the day. At the 18th he added a further quadruple bogey. Nobody had asked him to.

The curious detail is that his back nine still came in 12 shots better than his front. The outward holes, one concludes, had been grim in their own

right. His gross 30 over par was the worst score anyone in the field posted that day. It lifted Stuart Neumann clean out of the Wooden Spoon cellar and installed Meller there instead, last by 15 shots. The collapse was sudden. It was also complete.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 5, Round 2

TEG RECORDS
— Stuart Neumann's -9 is the best round in TEG history to date
— Stuart Neumann's +11 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date
— David Mullin's +11 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date

PERSONAL BESTS
— David Mullin posts a personal-best round: -4
— Gregg Williams posts a personal-best round: -6
— Stuart Neumann — +3 Gross on the Front nine is a personal-best Front nine Gross
RARE FEATS
— Henry Meller runs up a 10 (+5) at the 16th — his career-worst on a par-5